BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #26 · GENETICS AND FAMILY HISTORY

"It runs in my family, so I'm doomed."

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Where it often comes from

Watching a parent or relative suffer from a disease, addiction, or mental illness can make us feel that the same fate is sealed. Family patterns are real risk factors, but risk is not destiny, and fear of fate can paralyze us.

What Scripture teaches

God told Israel, "A son will not bear the iniquity of his father" (Ezekiel 18:20), and "each is to die for his own sin" (Deuteronomy 24:16). Moses wrote that the LORD is "compassionate and gracious, slow to anger, abounding in loving devotion." Jeremiah heard, "I know the plans I have for you… plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope." Genes may raise a risk, but choices, treatment, support, and God's grace matter. Many who are at risk never develop the condition, and many who do live well with it.

> *"For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope"* (Jeremiah 29:11).

Also see

> "The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him" (Ezekiel 18:20).

> "Fathers shall not be put to death for their children, nor children for their fathers; each is to die for his own sin" (Deuteronomy 24:16).

> "Then the LORD passed in front of Moses and called out: 'The LORD, the LORD God, is compassionate and gracious, slow to anger, abounding in loving devotion and faithfulness.'" (Exodus 34:6).

> "The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever— do not abandon the works of Your hands" (Psalm 138:8).

Common self-statements

- It is in my blood.
- I will get it too.
- There is no escape.
- My family curse will find me.
- Why try to prevent it?
- I am doomed.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I either have no risk or am doomed.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will repeat the family pattern.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling afraid and concluding that it is inevitable.
- Labeling: Calling myself doomed.

Challenging questions

- What does my doctor say about my actual risk?
- What steps can lower the risk or catch it early?
- What did my relative lack that I can have, such as treatment, support, or knowledge?
- Do I know family members who faced the same risk and did well?
- What does Scripture say about inherited guilt?
- What is one preventive step I can take?

Truth summary

> Risk is not destiny. God has plans for my future and hope, and I can take wise steps, get good medical advice, and trust Him with what I cannot control.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Anxiety/Worry
- Trust
- Hopeless
- Sickness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "It runs in my family, so I'm doomed"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"It runs in my family, so I'm doomed." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does my doctor say about my actual risk?
- ☐ What steps can lower the risk or catch it early?
- ☐ What did my relative lack that I can have, such as treatment, support, or knowledge?
- ☐ Do I know family members who faced the same risk and did well?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about inherited guilt?
- ☐ What is one preventive step I can take?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ A son will not bear his father's iniquity.
- ☐ God has plans for my future and hope.
- ☐ Risk is not destiny.
- ☐ I can take wise steps.
- ☐ God is gracious and compassionate.
- ☐ He will fulfill His purpose for me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Jeremiah 29:11
  "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope."
- ☐ Ezekiel 18:20
  "The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him."
- ☐ Deuteronomy 24:16
  "Fathers shall not be put to death for their children, nor children for their fathers; each is to die for his own sin."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Wise steps: Each month, note one healthy or preventive step you took.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Jeremiah 29:11 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God has plans for my future and hope.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Learn your actual risk. Ask your doctor about screening and prevention.
- [ ] Build healthy habits. Sleep, move, eat well, and reduce harmful substances.
- [ ] Get support. Talk to a counselor if fear dominates.
- [ ] Memorize Jeremiah 29:11. Say it when fear rises.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "It runs in my family, so I'm doomed": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Wise steps
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~It runs in my family, so I'm doomed.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I fear what runs in my family. Give me wisdom, wise doctors, and trust that my future is in Your hands. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.